

Storage of Elastomers

The optimum storage conditions for Elastomer products are described in DIN 7716 and ISO 2230. Adherence to these instructions allows the storage of Elastomers for a period of several years without reduction in quality.

The most harmful factors for accelerated ageing of Elastomers are

- mechanical stress (compression, tension, bending, ...),
- subjection to oxygen,
- ozone,
- light,
- heat,
- humidity
- and solvents.

For this reason, the following basic rules should be observed:

Warehouse

The warehouse should be cool, dry, dustfree and moderately aired. The relative humidity should not exceed 65%.

There should be no ozone producing electrical equipment set up in the warehouse. The warehouse should also not be simultaneously used for the storage of solvents, fuels, lubricants, chemicals or other gas emitting substances.

Storage temperature

The temperature should be approx. 15°C although fluctuations from +20°C to -10°C are permissible. Sources of heat e.g. radiators should be at a distance of at least 1m from the goods to avoid direct heat radiation.

Lighting

Elastomers must be protected from direct sunshine and artificial lighting with a high UV ratio. It is advisable to light the warehouse with conventional bulbs.

Packaging

Sealed packaging e.g. airtight containers or polyethylene bags protect the goods from the surrounding atmosphere and thereby from oxygen and ozone. Packaging materials may not include softeners or other substances harmful to elastomer.

Mechanical stress

Elastomer products should be stored stress-free. This means they should not be subjected to tension, compression, bending or any other stress.

Storage of components

Particular care must be taken in the storage of e.g. screw couplings with external, prefitted seals. The tensile stress of a stretched seal results in severe acceleration of the ageing process. For this reason, the stretching of a seal should be kept to a minimum in the constructive design.

Despite optimum storage conditions, the components should not be stored for long periods and is imperative they are promptly further processed in accordance with the principle of "first-in first-out".